

Generator Safety & Proper Use Guide

Important safety information for operating your backup power system.
Read before your first use.

Backfeeding

When a generator is connected to your panel without a proper interlock, electricity can flow backwards through the meter and onto utility lines. Lineworkers restoring power won't expect those wires to be live. This is called **backfeeding** and it can be fatal.

Never connect a generator to your panel without an interlock kit. The interlock mechanically prevents your main breaker and generator breaker from being on at the same time.

Carbon Monoxide

Generators produce carbon monoxide (CO), an odorless, colorless gas. Running a generator indoors, in a garage, or too close to windows can fill your home with lethal levels of CO in minutes.

Always run your generator outdoors, at least 20 feet from any door, window, or vent. Point the exhaust away from the house. Install CO detectors on every level of your home.

Overloading

Every generator has a maximum wattage rating. Running more appliances than your generator can handle will trip breakers, damage the generator, or damage your appliances. Know your capacity and stay within it.

Neutral Bonding

Your generator has an internal configuration called a neutral-to-ground bond. There are two types:

Bonded neutral: Neutral and ground are connected inside the generator. Most newer portables use this.

Floating neutral: Neutral and ground are separate. Some older or industrial generators use this.

When connected through an inlet, the bonding must match your panel. Your installer verifies this. **If you ever change generators, contact a licensed electrician before using the new one with your inlet.**



Safe Operation Checklist

- ✓ Run the generator **outdoors only**, at least 20 feet from doors, windows, and vents.
- ✓ Use only the power cord rated for your inlet (**30A or 50A**). Never substitute extension cords.
- ✓ Turn **OFF the generator breaker** before starting the generator.
- ✓ Start the generator and let it stabilize for **30 seconds** before engaging the interlock.
- ✓ Engage the interlock: **main breaker OFF, generator breaker ON.**
- ✓ Turn on circuits **one at a time**, heaviest loads first.
- ✓ Don't exceed your generator's **wattage capacity**.
- ✓ Point exhaust **away from your home**.
- ✓ Never refuel while **running or hot**.
- ✓ Test **CO detectors** monthly.
- ✓ Run generator **15-20 minutes monthly** to keep it ready.

If anything feels wrong, unusual smells, sparks, vibrations, or tripped breakers, shut down the

generator immediately and call a licensed electrician.

Ready to Get Connected Safely?

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